

together often, including the recent World Test Championship final. Last Saturday, he reminisced about watching it with “Mick” and praised Temba Bavuma’s captaincy.

I recall him calling late one night during the 2023 World Cup. Jagger was in India.

“I need your help,” Doshi said. What for? “Mick wants to post a message in Hindi for his fans. I’ve written something. Can you check if it reads well?”

We spent half an hour working on it. Eventually, the message went out. The next morning, I found a long message from Doshi, thanking me for the help. “We finished it in 30 minutes because it was a great partnership,” he wrote.

That was quintessential Doshi — serious but full of wit.

During the COVID-19 lockdown in 2020, he gave us a long interview on the art of spin bowling. The 5,000-word piece ran in *Sportstar’s* ebook (the print edition was paused then). That edition also carried an interview with Bishan Singh Bedi. When it came out, Doshi called me and said, “It’s not for nothing that Bishan is a legend. He’s spoken so well.” This, from a man whose own early career was overshadowed by Bedi. “He’s the best we have,” Doshi said. Then he spoke fondly of Chuni Goswami, the football captain and First-Class cricketer who once led Doshi.

I wasn’t even born when he played for India. But in school, I borrowed his autobiography ‘Spin Punch’ from a friend’s dad. It was one of the most explosive cricket memoirs I had read. Years later, I got to know the man behind it — affectionate, welcoming, and full of stories.

In our chats, he often quoted one of his favourite Rolling Stones songs:

“You can’t always get what you want

But if you try sometime

You’ll find you get what you need...”

Travel well, Dilip *da*. And thank you for the memories.



Spirited bond: Over the years, Dilip Doshi was a regular at cricket matches, often seen alongside his good friend Rolling Stones’ Mick Jagger. CAB



Warm remembrance: From nets in England to long chats later — Sachin Tendulkar and Dilip Doshi shared more than just passion for cricket. PTI